

Nicolas Polasek

PHD STUDENT · AGRICULTURAL AND RESOURCE ECONOMICS

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Education

University of California, Berkley

PHD AGRICULTURAL AND RESOURCE ECONOMICS

- Advisor: Prof. Jeremy Magruder

University of Geneva

MSc ECONOMICS

- Advisor: Prof. Giacomo De Giorgi

University of Geneva

BA INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

Berkeley, CA

August 2021 - May 2027

(expected)

Geneva, Switzerland

September 2017 - June 2019

Geneva, Switzerland

September 2012 - June 2016

Research

WORKING PAPERS

"Market Integration and the Effects of Internal Displacement on Host Communities" [Job Market Paper - Draft coming soon]

WORK IN PROGRESS

"The Social Penalty of Underemployment" with Eric Ochieng and Frederick Aila [Funding secured]

"The Effect of Cash Transfers and Village Savings Groups on Youth in Rural Settings: Evidence from the DRC" with Jeremy Magruder and Eleanor Wiseman [Experiment finalized]

"Natural Disasters and Social Policy: Evidence from Goma's youths" with Jeremy Magruder and Eleanor Wiseman [Experiment finalized]

"How does Agricultural Mechanization affect Labor Markets in Sub-Saharan Africa: the Case of Tractor Services in Nigeria"

Teaching Experience

Fall 2025 **Applied Statistics 1 (COMPSS 212)**, Graduate Student Instructor

Fall 2024 **Introductory Applied Econometrics (EEP 118)**, Graduate Student Instructor

Fall 2022 **Development Economics (EEP C151)**, Graduate Student Instructor

Research Assistance

2025 **Spring and Fall Semesters: Graduate Student Researcher**, for Prof. Jeremy Magruder, UC Berkeley

2024 **Spring: Graduate Student Researcher**, for Prof. Jeremy Magruder and Prof. Supreet Kaur, UC Berkeley

2023 **Graduate Student Researcher**, for Asst. Prof. Ellen Bruno, UC Berkeley

2021 **Research Assistant**, For Prof. Giacomo De Giorgi and Prof. Salvatore Di Falco, University of Geneva

Other Professional Experiences _____

- 2024 **Consultant - Research Assistant**, The World Bank
- 2020-2021 **Lead for Monitoring and Evaluation**, Centre Ecologique Albert Schweitzer, Switzerland
- 2019-2020 **Associate, Economic Security Unit**, International Committee of the Red Cross

Awards, Fellowships, & Grants _____

- 2026 **Research Grant**, Giannini Foundation for Agricultural Economics \$34,736.75
- Research Grant**, Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics \$14,430.00
- Merit Grant**, Swiss Benevolent Society of San Francisco \$5,000
- 2025 **Research Grant**, Giannini Foundation for Agricultural Economics \$25,000
- Student Opportunity Fund**, UC Berkeley Student Union \$1000
- 2024 **Development Economics Challenge**, Center for Effective Global Action \$5,500
- Sacheti Family Grant**, UC Berkeley Agricultural and Resource Economics Department \$3,000
- 2023-2022 **Travel Grant**, UC Berkeley Agricultural and Resource Economics Department (2x) \$3,000
- 2019 **Best Masters Dissertation Award**, Economics Department, University of Geneva CHF 1,000
- 2016 **Scholarship**, Fondation Barbour CHF 10,000

Presentations _____

- 2026 **North East Universities Development Consortium annual conference**, Ithaca, New York
- Development Economics Seminar**, University of California, Berkeley
- Agricultural and Resource Economics Departmental Seminar**, University of California, Berkeley
- 2026-2024 **Development Economics Lunch**, University of California, Berkeley 5x
- Development Workshop**, University of California, Berkeley 5x
- 2024 **Giannini Foundation of Agricultural and Resource Economics Student Conference (GARESC)**, Berkeley, California
- Poster: Africa Evidence Summit**, Dar Es Salaam, Tanzania,

Refereeing _____

Journal of Development Economics

Service & Mentoring _____

- 2025 **UC Berkeley ARE PhD Admissions Committee**, Committee Member
- 2024 **CEGA African Visiting Fellow Program**, Peer PhD Partner for Dr. Isaac Doku, Lecturer at the University of Education, Winneba, Ghana
- Undergraduate Honor Thesis Mentor**, Lakshmi Gopinathan, Undergraduate Student, University of California, Berkeley

Languages _____

French (native), English (fluent), Italian (fluent), Spanish (intermediate), German (elementary)